

Chrome's rising browser share

Chrome has hit 25 per cent of the browser market share, trailing Firefox by only 5 per cent. IE remains the king with 45 per cent

BlackBerry App World 3.0

RIM has finally rolled out the full-fledged 3.0 upgrade to its BlackBerry App World, weeks after it was made available to Beta Zone members

Web Watch

Yahoo uses Facebook to test six degrees of separation theory

Yahoo Research is testing whether the theory about six degrees of separation - that any two people can be shown to be connected through friends in six links or fewer - is true. And if you have a Facebook account, you can participate in the project, called "the Small World Experiment".

The Small World Experiment is designed to test whether anyone in the world can send a message to anyone else, randomly selected from a pool of Facebook users who agree to make themselves a "target", in six steps by passing it from friend to friend. Sociologists have long pondered whether

the theory has any teeth, but there's never been any solid evidence to support or disprove the idea.

This social experiment, open to anyone with a Facebook account (pending your approval to Yahoo's app accessing certain information about you), starts with becoming a "sender" or person at one end of the chain. You're then given a "target" or person you must try to reach in six steps or less. The volunteer target also provides some personal information, such as work



history, schools attended, age, current city of residence and spouse's name.

After perusing the fact sheet, senders must choose only one of their Facebook friends to start the chain. An email is sent to the person in question, and if they choose to participate, they'll follow the same procedure.

Through questionnaires, the researchers at Yahoo are collecting information about who participates in the chain. Additionally, if you opt to become a target (which anyone can do on completing one sender transaction), you're asked to fill out another questionnaire, which will become your profile sheet for the sender who receives you as a target. (Pro tip: We had better luck signing up and participating in Firefox than with Chrome).

The study is led by Principal Research Scientist at Yahoo Research, Duncan Watts, who was inspired by a 1967 experiment by Stanley Milgram at Harvard. 

The advertisement for the Adata SH14 External Hard Drive features a sleek, black, rectangular drive with a glossy finish. The drive is positioned on the right side of the frame, with a dynamic splash of water at its base. The background is a light blue sky with several meteorites streaking across it, leaving long, dark trails. The text "Stylish yet tough!" is prominently displayed in a bold, sans-serif font, followed by "SH14 External Hard Drive" in a slightly smaller font. In the bottom left corner, there are logos for USB 3.0, Facebook, and the Adata India website. The Adata logo itself is located in the bottom left corner of the advertisement, featuring a colorful bird and the text "ADATA Love Life Dreams".



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